



Epic: A Web Browser by Indians for Indians

Epic is a Web browser that not only offers easy access to localised Indian content, and supports 12 Indian languages, but also includes an integrated word processor and an anti-virus scanner.

By: Onkar Sharma, LFY Bureau

Last month, an Indian start-up named Hidden Reflex grabbed the spotlight by becoming the first-ever Indian company to have launched an Indian Web browser—Epic. Based on Mozilla's open source Firefox platform, it offers accessibility to a lot of Indian content, support for various Indian languages, and other security and productivity features.

Epic comes with a word processor

Epic offers its users various easy-to-use features to explore Indian content on the Web. Its creators have pitched it

as 'a Web browser for India'.

"Epic provides a uniquely Indian browsing experience. Epic's India sidebar provides users with Indian content: access to the latest national and regional news from popular publications, live television channels, videos, stock quotes, live cricket scores, top music albums, and local events. Users can choose from over

1500 customised Indian themes and wallpapers, ranging from freedom

fighters to famous Bollywood and regional film stars," elaborates Alok Bhardwaj, founder and CEO, Hidden Reflex.

Since Epic supports 12 Indian languages, Indian users can type in their preferred local language "... on any Web page, or in Epic Write, Epic's free built-in word processor," explains Bhardwaj. It's not a traditional word processor, and lacks the voluminous features offered by Open Office or MS Office. Nevertheless, it is an interesting feature, especially when it saves you from opening a word processor separately, to make quick notes.

Security features

Since it's been built on the Mozilla Firefox platform, obviously Epic includes all of Firefox's security features. Epic

also comes with an integrated free anti-virus scanner, which is not a feature you'd expect in a browser. Like the word processor, this too isn't a full-fledged real-time anti-virus solution that shields your whole system from malware. "Once activated, it automatically scans downloaded files for viruses, and can also scan your whole computer system for viruses, and try to heal them. But, to be clear, it doesn't include a real-time scanner," reveals Bhardwaj. In addition, like Firefox, it warns users when visiting malware-ridden Web pages.

Multi-tasking sidebar and the Epic Apps Store

Unlike other browsers, Epic allows you easy access to your favourite content through its sidebar applications. According to Hidden Reflex, the Epic Apps Store offers over 1500 free-to-install sidebar applications. "The sidebar apps include our Video Sidebar, which lets you watch videos in the sidebar while you browse, and also supports downloading videos. In addition, we have sidebars for Gmail, Yahoo Mail, Twitter, Orkut and Facebook, among others," says Bhardwaj.

Installing it on Linux

Although the browser has been built on an open source platform, it does not (as yet) offer direct installation support for Linux-based machines. You currently need to install it using the Wine platform (www.winehq.org; "... a free software application that allows computer programs written for MS Windows to run on UNIX-like operating systems."—Wikipedia). "However, Hidden Reflex will soon come up with versions for Linux and Mac computers," adds Bhardwaj.

To conclude: Epic can be a good option for users who want easy access to Indian content. If you already use Firefox, you can make Epic your secondary browser—because, unlike other browsers, it never asks to be your primary Web browser. It may or may not be the best Web browser for Indians—that's for you to decide; but if you want to give it a try, visit www.epicbrowser.com.



Alok Bhardwaj, founder and CEO, Hidden Reflex